

KNIGHT SCHOOL | 4-WEEK LESSON PLAN

PROGRAM

Forming True Templar Knights: Becoming a Monk Before a Warrior

Program Overview

The Knight School represents the pinnacle of formation within our Order. Its primary purpose is not to teach martial prowess, but to forge men of God who understand that true knighthood begins with inward consecration. A true Templar knight must first be a monk before he is a warrior.

This 4-week program emphasizes the absolute necessity of prayer, Scripture, humility, and obedience. Only a heart subdued by the Holy Spirit can be trusted with the authority of knighthood. Candidates will be tested on their commitment to charity, courage, restraint, and selfless service. You are called to bear the cross before you bear the sword.

Week 1: The Calling of a Knight

Focus: Monk before warrior; inward consecration before outward rank. The first step toward true knighthood is the surrender of personal ambition. A knight's strength is not derived from his own might, but from his complete reliance on God. Before an aspirant can wear the mantle of a knight, his heart must be consecrated to the Lord in silence, humility, and devotion.

Key Formation Points

- Understanding the monastic foundation of the original Templar Order.
- The danger of seeking outward titles without inward spiritual maturity.
- Cultivating a lifestyle of hidden devotion and private prayer.
- Embracing the call to die to oneself in order to live for Christ.

Reflection Questions:

- In what areas of your life are you seeking outward recognition over inward purity?

- What does the phrase "monk before warrior" demand of you personally?

Discussion Questions:

- Why is a warrior without the discipline of a monk dangerous to the Order and the Church?
- How do we maintain a spirit of inward consecration in a culture obsessed with outward success?

Week 2: Rule of Life

Focus: Prayer, Scripture, obedience, discipline, accountability, and self-mastery. A knight cannot defend the faithful if he cannot govern himself. This week focuses on establishing a strict, personal Rule of Life. Routine spiritual disciplines anchor the soul, preventing the knight from being swept away by the passions of the flesh or the chaos of the world.

Key Formation Points

- Structuring a daily rhythm of prayer and Scripture reading.
- The absolute necessity of obedience to legitimate authority.
- Practicing self-mastery over appetites, time, and desires.
- Living in transparent accountability with brothers in the Order.

Reflection Questions:

- Where is your current daily routine lacking in spiritual discipline?
- How do you respond internally when you are given an order you dislike?

Discussion Questions:

- How does a structured Rule of Life create spiritual freedom rather than legalistic bondage?
- What role does accountability play in preventing moral failure in leadership?

Week 3: Virtue in Action

Focus: Charity, protection of the weak, honorable speech, courage with restraint, mercy, justice, and brotherhood. True virtue is tested in the crucible of daily interactions. A knight is recognized not merely by his vows, but by his active charity and the restraint of his power. He speaks truth with honor, executes justice with mercy, and protects those who cannot protect themselves.

Key Formation Points

- The active practice of charity and mercy toward the marginalized.
- The discipline of the tongue: avoiding gossip, slander, and boastfulness.
- Demonstrating courage through restraint and measured responses.
- Fostering genuine Christian brotherhood and unity within the Order.

Reflection Questions:

- When is it more courageous for you to show restraint than to take action?
- Does your speech consistently reflect honor, truth, and charity?

Discussion Questions:

- How do we actively protect the weak and vulnerable in our modern society?
- Why is brotherly unity essential for the spiritual effectiveness of the Order?

Week 4: Knightly Witness and Readiness

Focus: Spiritual warfare, steadfastness, service, leadership through humility, and final readiness for knightly responsibility. The culmination of this training is the recognition that knighthood is a lifelong deployment in spiritual warfare. A knight leads by washing feet, serves without expectation of reward, and stands fast when others flee.

Key Formation Points

- Putting on the full armor of God to withstand spiritual attacks.
- Embracing servant leadership as the only legitimate form of Christian authority.
- Maintaining steadfastness and fidelity during periods of trial and isolation.
- Final self-examination regarding readiness for the solemn vows of knighthood.

Reflection Questions:

- Are you prepared to accept the burdens of leadership without the praises of men?

- What vulnerabilities currently exist in your spiritual armor?

Discussion Questions:

- What does it mean practically to engage in spiritual warfare as a Templar today?
- How will you ensure that your promotion to Knight results in greater service rather than greater pride?

Optional Supplemental Books by Week

Note: The following readings are entirely optional, non-tested, and provided solely for the personal spiritual enrichment and deeper formation of the candidate.

- **Week 1:** *"In Praise of the New Knighthood"* by Bernard of Clairvaux; *The Rule of Saint Benedict*
- **Week 2:** *"The Practice of the Presence of God"* by Brother Lawrence; *"Celebration of Discipline"* by Richard J. Foster
- **Week 3:** *"Mere Christianity"* by C.S. Lewis; *"The Imitation of Christ"* by Thomas à Kempis
- **Week 4:** *"Life Together"* by Dietrich Bonhoeffer; *"The Pilgrim's Progress"* by John Bunyan

Schoolmaster Note

Promotion to the rank of Knight is a solemn trust, not an automatic right or a mere acknowledgment of academic completion. As Schoolmasters and mentors, you are tasked with observing the inward character and outward conduct of the Aspirant. Look for genuine humility, a steadfast prayer life, and a servant's heart. An Aspirant who knows all the answers but lacks charity and obedience is not ready to bear the cross of knighthood. Guide them with firm love, holding them to the highest standard of Christian chivalry.